

Academic Appointments

KTH Royal Institute of Technology

PostDoctoral Researcher, Department of Computing and Learning Systems

Focus: Missing Data – Reimagining AI Systems to Challenge Structural Silences

Stockholm, Sweden

2025 - present

Education

Linköping University

PhD, Visualization and Media Technology

- Faculty of Science and Engineering
- Advisor: Miriah Meyer, Co-Advisor: Lauren Klein
- Wallenberg AI, Autonomous Systems, and Software Program (WASP) Program Graduate
- Thesis: [Shifting Perspectives: Conducting Visualization Research with Entanglement Epistemology](#)

Norrköping, Sweden

2022 - 2025

University of Utah

MSc, Computing

Focus: Data Visualization; Human-Centered Computing

Salt Lake City, UT

2019 - 2022

Cornell University

BSc, Industrial & Labor Relations

Minors: Economics; Cognitive Science

Ithaca, NY

2010 - 2013

Publications

AWARDS & HONORS

- 2026 Seal of Excellence, Horizon Europe MSCA Postdoctoral Fellowship
Recognized as a high-quality project proposal in a highly competitive evaluation process, but could not receive funding due to budgetary constraints.
- 2025 Best Paper Honorable Mention
IEEE VIS for paper [C6] (top 5%)
- 2024 Best Paper Award
IEEE VIS for paper [C5] (top 1%)

CONFERENCE AND JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS (REFEREED)

- [C9] **D. Akbaba**, D. Paz Moyano Dávila, M. Gezelius, Y. He, M. Meyer. *Designing Vibes in a Science Museum: from @Science to @🧐*. In Proceedings of the 2026 Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '26). Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 2125–2139.
DOI: [10.1145/3800645.3813762](https://doi.org/10.1145/3800645.3813762)
- [C8] J. Rogers, **D. Akbaba**, J.S. Brown, A. Lex, M. Meyer, *Reflections on Traceability for Visualization Research*, Computer Graphics Forum (Proceedings of EuroVis), 2026.
DOI: [10.1111/cgf.70445](https://doi.org/10.1111/cgf.70445)
- [C7] **D. Akbaba**, C. Svensson, C. Torelli, M. Callmeryd, M. Meyer, *Thinking Inside the Box: Considerations for Putting Data Physicalization Workshops in a Box*, Computer Graphics Forum (Proceedings of EuroVis), 2026.
DOI: [10.1111/cgf.70453](https://doi.org/10.1111/cgf.70453)
- [C6] H. Lin, M. Lisnic, **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer, A. Lex. *Here's what you need to know about my data: Exploring Expert Knowledge's Role in Data Analysis*. IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS 2025), 32(1):11186-11196, 2026. [Honorable Mention](#).
DOI: [10.1109/TVCG.2025.3634821](https://doi.org/10.1109/TVCG.2025.3634821)

- [C5] **D. Akbaba**, L. Klein, M. Meyer. *Entanglements for Visualization: Changing Research Outcomes through Feminist Theory*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS 2024), 31(1):1279-1289, 2025.
Best Paper Award.
DOI: [10.1109/TVCG.2024.3456171](https://doi.org/10.1109/TVCG.2024.3456171)
- [C4] T. Kauer, **D. Akbaba**, M. Dörk and B. Bach, *Discursive Patinas: Anchoring Discussions in Data Visualizations*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS 2024), 31(1):1246-1256, 2025.
DOI: [10.1109/TVCG.2024.3456334](https://doi.org/10.1109/TVCG.2024.3456334)
- [C3] **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer. “Two Heads are Better than One”: *Pair-Interviews for Visualization*. Short Paper. IEEE Visualization and Visual Analytics (VIS), 206-210, 2023.
DOI: [10.1109/VIS54172.2023.00050](https://doi.org/10.1109/VIS54172.2023.00050)
- [C2] **D. Akbaba**, D. Lange, M. Correll, A. Lex, M. Meyer, *Troubling collaboration: Matters of care for visualization design study*, In Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 1-15, 2025.
DOI: [10.1145/3544548.3581168](https://doi.org/10.1145/3544548.3581168)
- [C1] H. Lin, **D. Akbaba**, M. Meyer, and A. Lex, *Data Hunches: Incorporating Personal Knowledge into Visualizations*, IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics (Proceedings of VIS 2022), 29(1):504–514, 2023.
DOI: [10.1109/TVCG.2022.3209451](https://doi.org/10.1109/TVCG.2022.3209451)

WORKSHOP PAPERS & EXTENDED ABSTRACTS (LIGHTLY REFEREED)

- [P12] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah *Interaction Criticism for Narrative Visualizations*, Critical Computing Conference, 2026.
Extended abstract.
- [P12] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah *Ecofeminist AI*, Data Justice Conference, 2026.
Extended abstract.
- [P11] **D. Akbaba**, *Craft, Reflection + Complexity*, CHI Workshop, 2026.
DOI: [10.17605/OSF.IO/E4R9M](https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/E4R9M)
- [P10] **D. Akbaba**, *The Value of Visualization Literacy*, CHI Workshop, 2026.
DOI: [10.17605/OSF.IO/4N7RH](https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/4N7RH)
- [P9] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah, *Unpacking Technology Through Interdisciplinary Reflection*, WASP/WASP-HS/DDLS conference, 2026.
Extended abstract.
- [P8] **D. Akbaba**, L. Rahm, A. Payberah, *Ecofeminist AI*, Data Justice Lab, 2026.
Extended abstract.
- [P7] B. Vincenzi, N. Campo Woytuk, A. Gómez Ortega, K. Sauvé, L. Forlano, **D. Akbaba**, E. Forero, S. Thulin, P. Sanches, K. Kuksenok. *Bring Your Own Biodata (BYOB): Feminist, Corporeal and Collective Approaches to Datafied Bodies*. Workshop. Companion Publication of the 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference, 2025.
DOI: [0.1145/3715668.3734162](https://doi.org/10.1145/3715668.3734162)
- [P6] T. Villalobos Lujan, P. Sengupta, **D. Akbaba**, S. Alessio-Robles, A. L. Dogan, M. Meltis, F. Shokooh Valle, L. Oehlberg. *Interaction Design as a Form of Decolonial Care*. Workshop. Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Creativity and Cognition, 2025.
DOI: [10.1145/3698061.3728395](https://doi.org/10.1145/3698061.3728395)
- [P5] **D. Akbaba**. *words matter || mattering words*. A Toolbox of Feminist Wonder: Theories and methods that can make a difference, CSCW, 2023.
Extended abstract.
- [P4] **D. Akbaba***, E. Kaklopoulou*. *A speculative feminist knowledge elicitation system*. AI for Humanity and Society, WASP-HS, 2023.
Extended abstract. *Denotes equal contribution.
- [P3] T. Kauer, **D. Akbaba**. *“I Was Here: Digital Traces as Design Material*. Information+ Conference, 2023.
Extended abstract.

- [P2] **D. Akbaba**, L. Klein, M. Meyer. *Reflections on applying feminist theory to visualization research*. Extended Abstract. Information+ Conference, 2022.
Extended abstract.
- [P1] **D. Akbaba**, J. Wilburn, M. T. Nance, M. Meyer. *Manifesto for Putting ‘Chartjunk’ in the Trash 2021!*. alt.vis, IEEE VIS, 2021.
DOI: [10.48550/arXiv.2109.10132](https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2109.10132)

REPORTS, EDITOR LETTERS, & SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

- [O4] G. Panagiotidou, A. McNutt, **D. Akbaba**, N. Hengesbach, M. Meyer. *Critical Data Visualization–Part II*. Guest Editors’ Introduction. IEEE Computer Graphics and Applications, 45(4):11–13, 2025.
DOI: [10.1109/MCG.2025.3585321](https://doi.org/10.1109/MCG.2025.3585321)
- [O3] G. Panagiotidou, A. McNutt, **D. Akbaba**, N. Hengesbach, M. Meyer. *Critical Data Visualization–Part I*. Guest Editors’ Introduction. IEEE Computer Graphics and Applications, 45(3):14–16, 2025.
DOI: [10.1109/MCG.2025.3579638](https://doi.org/10.1109/MCG.2025.3579638)
- [O2] J. Drucker, M. El-Assady, U. Hinrichs, F. Windhager, **D. Akbaba**. *Visualization and the Humanities: Towards a Shared Research Agenda (Dagstuhl Seminar 23381)*. Report. Schloss Dagstuhl-Leibniz-Zentrum für Informatik, 2024.
DOI: [10.4230/DagRep.13.9.137](https://doi.org/10.4230/DagRep.13.9.137)
- [O1] **D. Akbaba**. *Visualizing Uncertainty: What can graphics convey about the character of data?*. Science Communication. Natural History Magazine, 2020.
Personal copy available upon request.

IN PREPARATION / UNDER REVIEW

- [R2] A. McNutt, **D. Akbaba**, M. Lisnic, G. Panagiotidou. *Zooming Out From Insight: Synthesizing Power in Visualization*, Under Review, IEEE VIS, 2026.
- [R1] C. Blomgren, **D. Akbaba**, R. Wyatt, M. Meyer, *The Challenges and Opportunities of Giving Credit in Science Museums*, Under Review, IEEE VIS, 2026.

Professional Service + Teaching

REVIEWING

IEEE VIS	Full Papers (’26, ’25, ’24, ’23, ’22), alt.vis (’23, ’22), VISAP (’26, ’25)
ACM CHI	Full Papers (’26, ’25), alt.chi (’25)
ACM DIS	Full Papers (’25), Pictorials (’26)
FAccT	Full Papers (’26)
Eurovis	Education Papers (’26)
ACM C&C	Pictorials (’25)
IEEE TVCG	Journal (’26, ’25, ’23)
Frontiers	Journal (’24)

SERVICE

- 2026 ACM DIS ’27 Organizing Committee
VIS Arts Program (IEEE VIS affiliated event) Program Committee
vis4climate (IEEE VIS Workshop) Program Committee
- 2025 CG&A Critical Visualization (Special issue) Guest Editor
Input Visualization (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
VIS Arts Program (IEEE VIS affiliated event) Program Committee
Bring Your Own Biodata (ACM DIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
- 2024 VISions for the Future (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee

- EuroVis Student Volunteer
- 2023 alt.vis (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
- Information+ Conference Organizing Committee
- 2022 alt.vis (IEEE VIS Workshop) Organizing Committee
- Eyeo Festival Student Volunteer
- 2021 Fair pay (IEEE VIS panel) Organizer
- 2020 IEEE VIS Student Volunteer
- College of Engineering Diversity Committee (U. of Utah) Grad Student Body Representative

ADVISING

- S2026 Omar Yair Ríos Trejo MSc in Machine Learning, KTH Royal Institute of Technology
- S2026 Stella Wilson MSc in Machine Learning, KTH Royal Institute of Technology
- S2024 Camilla Svensson MSc of Design, Linköping University
- S2024 Claudia Torelli MSc of Design, Linköping University
- S2021 Pranav Rajan BSc of Computer Science, University of Utah

UNIVERSITY TEACHING

- S2026 AK2202: Gender and Technology Guest Instructor, KTH
- F2025 FID3216: Data Feminism Guest Instructor, KTH
- S2024 TDDE39: Physical Interaction Design and Prototyping Guest Instructor, Linköping University
- F2024 FID3216: Data Feminism Guest Instructor, KTH
- F2023 TNM101: Advanced Visualization Design Guest Instructor, Linköping University
- S2023 TDDE39: Physical Interaction Design and Prototyping Guest Instructor, Linköping University
- S2020 COMP1010: Programming for All Teaching Mentor, University of Utah

NON-UNIVERSITY TEACHING ¹

- S2026 Making the Invisible Visible: Counterdata, Hidden Labor, and Community-Centric AI for Justice Workshop, IASEAI Conference, France
- F2025 Mapping as a Social Science Method Workshop, Maastricht University, the Netherlands
- F2024 Data Crafting for Team Leaders Workshop, Östergötlands Stadsmission, Sweden
- S2024 Data Crafting for Young Children Workshop, Visualiseringscenter C, Sweden
- S2024 Data Crafting for Empowerment & Expression Workshops, Östergötlands Stadsmission, Sweden
- S2024 Feminist Data Visualization Seminar + Workshop, Graphic Hunters Beautiful Data Series, virtual
- S2022 Introduction to Data Science Workshop, Women Tech Council, Utah

Selected Experience

INTERDISCIPLINARY ENGAGEMENTS

- | | | |
|------|--|---------|
| 2025 | FemTech and Feminist Tech Focus Period, 3-day workshop about technology design @ KTH | Sweden |
| 2024 | NORDES Summer school, Week focused on socio-ecologically just design after progress | Sweden |
| | Digital STS Hub, Science and technology studies group sharing & supporting research | Sweden |
| | Feminist Wonder Working Group, Interdisciplinary HCI scholars developing a toolbox of feminist methods/methodologies | virtual |

¹An important aspect of my pedagogical praxis is to extend my teaching efforts outside of traditional university spaces. I achieve this through workshops and seminars with non-profit organizations and professional groups, reaching a diverse range of age groups and communities.

2023	Dagstuhl Seminar , Week-long event on topic of: "Visualization and the Humanities: Towards a Shared Research Agenda"	Germany
2022	STEM Ambassador, Spring Cohort , Semester long program run by U of Utah, that trains and supports communicating science efforts to the public	USA
2020	CRA-WP Grad Cohort for Women , Conference that supports women in computing	virtual
	ComSciCon 2020 Flagship Workshop , Workshop for training and supporting science communication to public	virtual
	Critical Code Studies , Working group to discuss code from critical theoretical perspectives	virtual
2019	School for Poetic Computation , Member of Code, Paper, Scissor Cohort examining material aspects of code	USA

AFFILIATIONS

2026, ongoing	Feminist Pedagogies for Just and Accountable AI , Research network across three European institutes for designing feminist AI education	SE, UK
2025, ongoing	ColibrAI , Research network across three European institutes for co-liberative development of AI	SE, FI, DE

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

2025	Data & Me Exhibit , Exhibit at local science museum [news] [news]	Sweden
	Data Crafting Workshops , Data physicalization workshops for children at science center	Sweden
2024	Östergötland Stadsmission Workshops , Data physicalization workshops for empowerment [news]	Sweden

VISITING RESEARCHER

2021	Polarization Lab, Duke University , Conducted study with Dr. Chris Bail on computational sociology	USA
2020	Marc Lab, University of Utah , Conducted study with Drs. Bryan Jones and Crystal Sigulinsky on neurobiology	USA

Presentation + Talks

2026	Thinking Inside the Box: Considerations for Putting Data Physicalization Workshops in a Box , Eurovis	UK
	Exploring entangled threads in visualization research , SIGCHI Paris Chapter	France
2025	Care, Craft, & Complexity , Visualizing Knowledge Conference	Finland
	Exploring entangled threads in visualization research , Lecture Series at ITU Copenhagen	Denmark
	Exploring New Threads in Visualization Research , FFF at KTH	Sweden
	Responsible Computing: Sketching a different future for VIS research , VIG at Utrecht University	Netherlands
	Responsible Computing: Sketching a different future for VIS research , VIS Cluster at TU Eindhoven	Netherlands
	Are visualizations haunted? , Cest-la-viz Conference	Netherlands
	Changing Research Outcomes through Feminist Theory , Best Paper Session at IEEE VIS	USA
	Changing Research Outcomes through Feminist Theory , Atlanta Interdisciplinary Artificial Intelligence Network at Emory University	USA
	Responsible Computing: Sketching a different future for VIS research , University of Utah	USA
	Data Empowerment , Östergötlands Stadsmission	Sweden
	Feminist Data Visualization , Beautiful Data sessions by Graphic Hunters	virtual
2023	Troubling Collaboration: Matters of Care in Visualization Design Study , CHI Conference	Germany
	Troubling Collaboration: Matters of Care in Visualization Design Study , ITU Copenhagen	Denmark
	Staying with the Trouble: Applying Feminism to Visualization Research , King's College London	UK
	Staying with the Trouble: Applying Feminism to Visualization Research , City, University of London	UK

Staying with the Trouble: Applying Feminism to Visualization Research, CIM at University of Warwick
2021 Manifesto for Putting “Chartjunk” in the Trash 2021!, alt.vis Workshop at IEEE VIS
Interactive Visualizations in Social Science Networks, Polarization Lab at Duke University

UK
virtual
USA